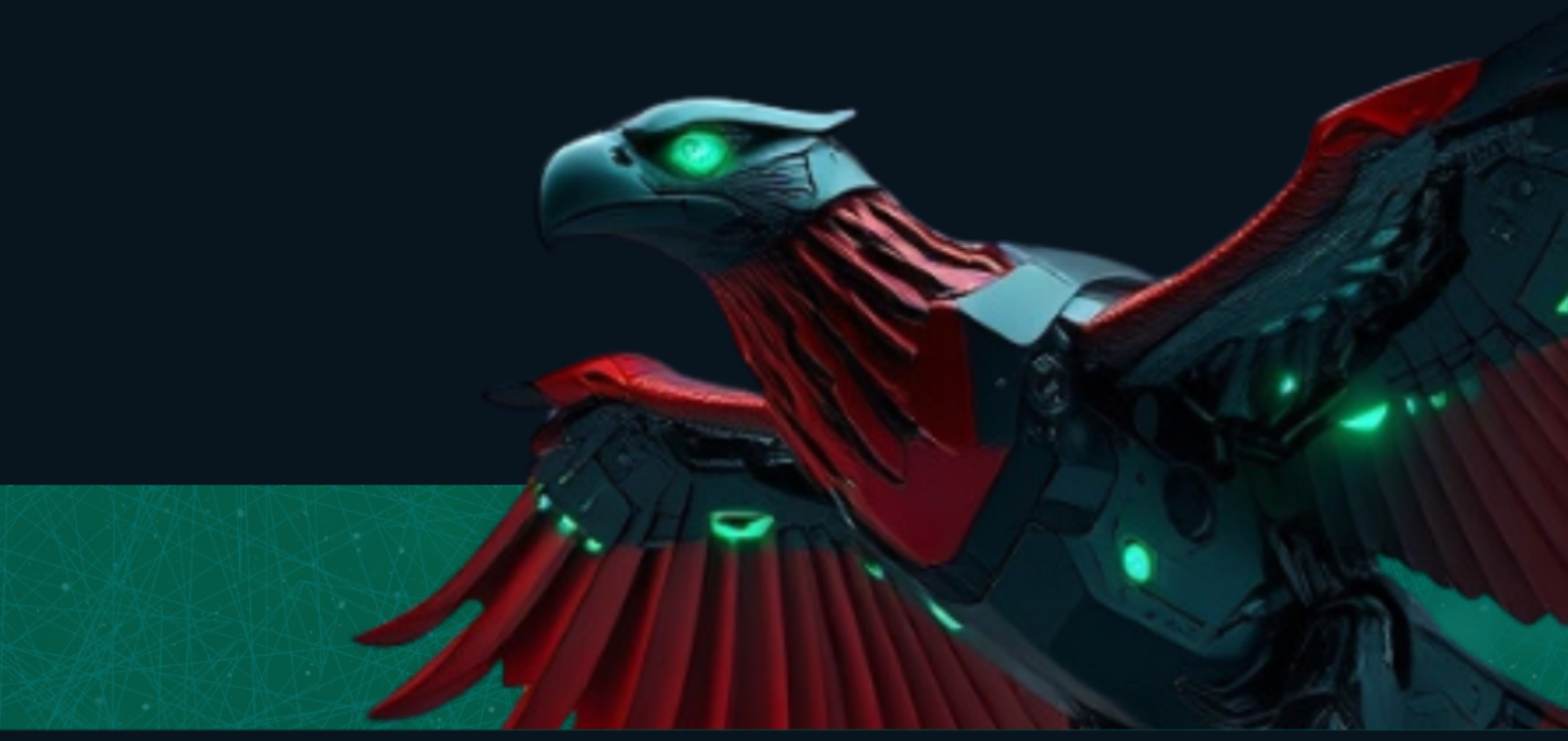
SOCBYTE
ALL BYTES SECURED

CASE REPORT



Case Details

Reference ID	CTHTY-255
Title	Suspicious memory dump of PID 840 to local temp file for user credentials
Status	Closed
Severity	High
Tactics	Credential Access
Created By	christopher.mirro@thevsoc.com
Created At	Aug 19, 2026, 08:28 PM
Category	Stealth
Sub-Category	System Script Proxy Execution
Tenant	Cythority
Age	5 seconds
Offense ID	—

Groups & Contributors

Assigned Groups

SOC-Cythority

Contributors

christopher.mirro@thevsoc.com

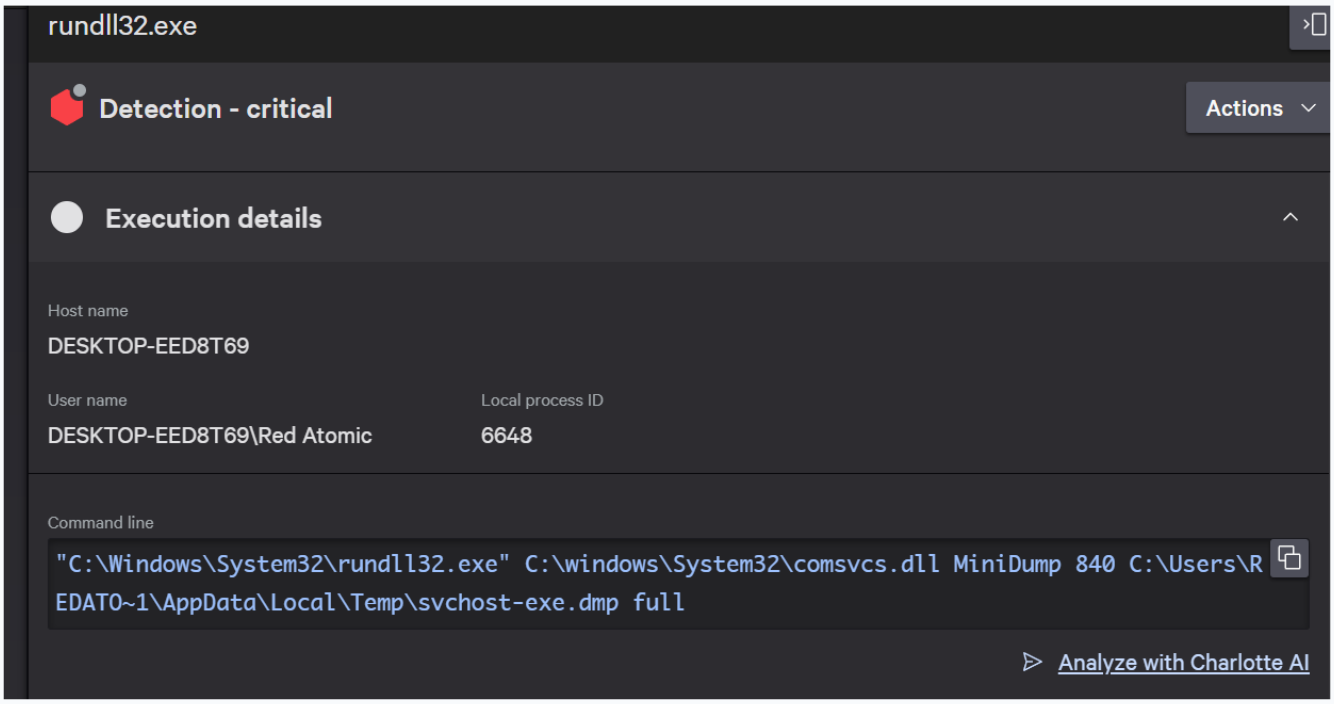
Analysis Summary

On August 19th, 2026 at 7:38 PM , Cythrority's VSOC investigated a Critical detection on Crowstrike Falcon. A local process called rundll32.exe was executed via Powershell.exe to run a function inside comsvcs.dll. This pulled a full memory dump of a targeted service host process, PID 840, and saved it to C:\Users\REDATO~1\AppData\Local\Temp\svchost-exe.dmp. These native tools were abused to dump active process memory into a temporary folder. The activity ran locally on Desktop-EED8T69. PID 840 is SVCHost.exe, which often handles critical system services that process or cache sensitive tokens, service passwords, and domain credentials in memory. If an attacker gets this dump file, they can extract those credentials offline using tools like mimikatz. Stolen credentials or session tokens could allow an adversary to jump to other systems across the domain, escalate privileges, or access restricted internal network resources. Utilizing the MITRE framework, we see examples of T1218.010 - System binary proxy execution (Abuse of native, signed rundll32.exe to execute arbitrary DLL code and bypass basic application control), T103.001 - OS credential dumping: LSASS memory (Using

comsvcs.dll Minidump to write process memory to disk to harvest credentials or security tokens offline.), and T1059.01 - Command and scripting interpreter: Powershell (Parent process executing the command line to trigger rundll32.exe.). No malicious IOCs were found as the attacker used living-off-the-land techniques to utilize clean commands to execute the memory dump.

Upon further investigation, based on the execution telemetry, process lineage, and environmental context, this activity is classified as a true positive. The process rundll32.exe (PID 6648) was invoked using a classic living-off-the-land binary technique targeting C:\windows\system32\comsvcs.dll and its export Minidump function. The command directly targeted PID 840 (an instance running svchost.exe process.), to create a full memory dump. The full process dump was then exported to an unprivileged users temporary folder (C:\Users\REDATO~1\AppData\Local\Temp\svchost-exe.dmp), making it easily accessible for exfiltration or offline parsing via credential-extraction tools. The execution was spawned programmatically via powershell.exe and completed in under one second (<1s), indicating an automated script or post-exploitation tool executing rapid credential harvesting rather than an interactive user session.

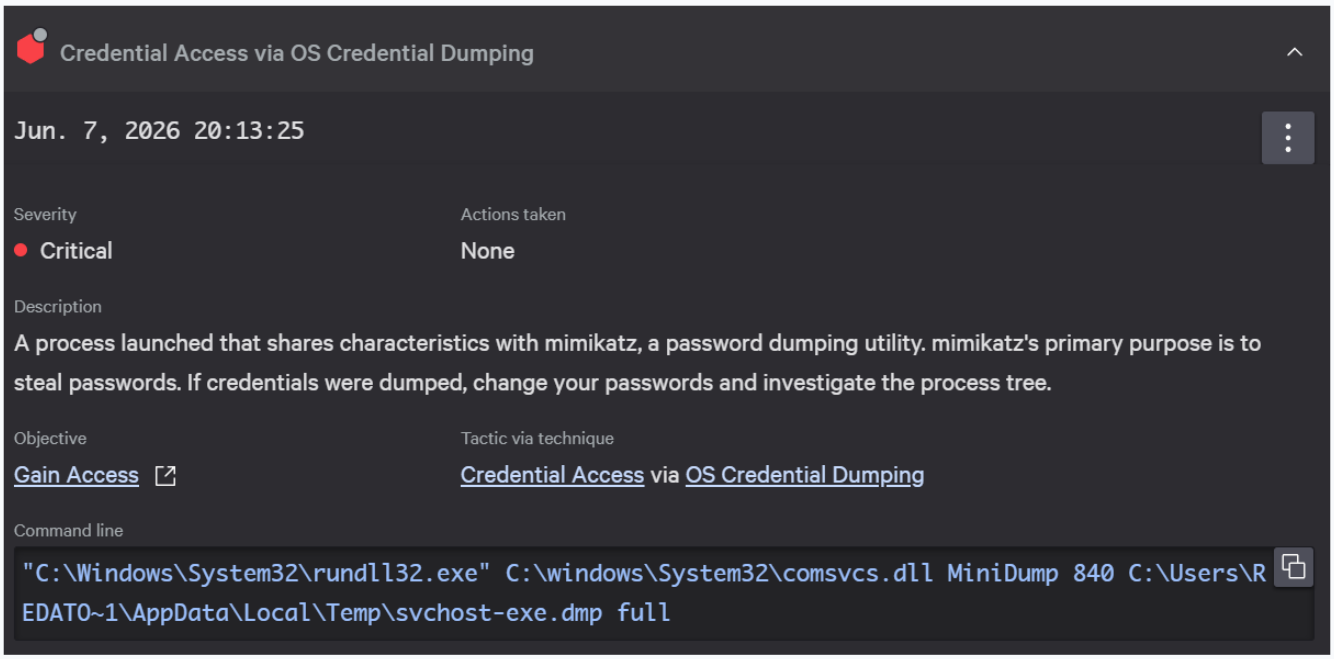
Evidence



Evidence 1


DESKTOP-EED8T69
svchost.exe
...k DcomLaunch -p
RuntimeB...ker.exe
....exe -Embedding
powershell.exe
...owershell.exe"
...ATOMICREDTEAM\"
cmd.exe
...intenance" /f)
cmd.exe
...ontExist.dll /f
reg.exe
...ontExist.dll /f
powershell.exe
...rshell\"" -ets}
cmd.exe
...Powershell -ets
PsExec.exe
...Powershell -ets
cmd.exe
... REG_DWORD /d 0
reg.exe
... REG_DWORD /d 0
powershell.exe
...Word\"" -Force}
powershell.exe
...ring\"" -Force}
powershell.exe
...ring\"" -Force}
cmd.exe
...secdump.exe" -a
powershell.exe
...\NPPSpy.txt\""}
conhost.exe
...ffffff -ForceV1
powershell.exe
...t-exe.dmp full}
rundll32.exe
...st-exe.dmp full
powershell.exe

Evidence 2



Evidence 3

Remediation

• Host Isolation: Immediately isolate DESKTOP-EED8T69 from the network via the Falcon console to contain potential lateral movement.

• Artifact Cleanup: Terminate any remaining suspicious parent processes and delete the dumped file (C:\Users\REDATO~1\AppData\Local\Temp\svchost-exe.dmp).

• Credential Reset: Force a password reset for all user and service accounts logged into or active on DESKTOP-EED8T69 around the time of the execution (Jun. 7, 2026, 20:12 UTC).

• Forensic Analysis: Triage the host to identify the initial access vector that allowed powershell.exe to spawn this command chain.